

Planetar — \$25,000 validation sprint

A focused, TRL-raising sprint that turns a working open-source maritime-domain-awareness system into a fundable, sellable one: a published dark-vessel benchmark, a reproducible deployment, and a first design partner.

Applicant **Steven Ness** Location **Victoria, BC** Award requested **\$25,000 CAD**

CATEGORY	JUSTIFICATION	AMOUNT (CAD)
Live-data validation campaign	Measure dark-vessel detection and cross-sensor re-identification performance on real Salish Sea traffic (live AIS + Sentinel-1 SAR + ONC hydrophone), reported as an open benchmark (precision/recall, latency). The evidence that unlocks pilots and follow-on funding.	12,000
Packaged, reproducible deployment	Containerize the stack with install docs and a commodity-hardware profile so a design partner can run it themselves. What a partner actually deploys.	5,000
Design-partner pilot	Structured customer discovery plus one scoped trial with a port authority, DFO fisheries enforcement, or a marine-conservation NGO. First customer evidence.	4,000
Compute & data	Sentinel-1 scene processing, AIS feed, and hosting the live planetar.ca demonstrator through the sprint. Core demonstration data (AIS, Sentinel-1) are public and free.	3,000
Contingency	Reserve for paid data access if a public source proves insufficient, or overruns in the validation runs.	1,000
Total requested		\$25,000

NOTES

- **Founder time** covers the R&D and validation work in the first line — confirm this is an eligible expense category against the OSC program information kit; if founder salary is ineligible, re-tag it as contract R&D / validation labour or shift weight to the pilot and compute lines.
- Applying as an **individual** (Steven Ness); a new Canadian entity will be incorporated on selection, before funds are released.
- All amounts in Canadian dollars. Figures are a draft for founder review — adjust the split before upload.